FOR SCHOOL & IEP MEETINGS

SETD5 Syndrome: *School & IEP Appointment Guide*

setd5syndrome.live

WHAT IS SETD5 SYNDROME?

SETD5 Syndrome is a rare genetic condition caused by a variant in the SETD5 gene on chromosome 3 (3p25.3). It affects brain development, resulting in intellectual disability, developmental delays, behavioral differences, and variable physical features. Most cases are de novo (not inherited). No two individuals share the exact same presentation, and severity varies widely. SETD5 Syndrome is likely unfamiliar to most school staff; this handout is designed to orient your child's team quickly.

FEATURES RELEVANT TO SCHOOL AND LEARNING

Not every individual will have all features listed. Severity varies widely, even among people with the same variant type.

LEARNING & BEHAVIORAL

- Intellectual disability (mild to moderate in most)
- 'Spiky' cognitive profile: strengths alongside challenges
- Working memory and short-term memory difficulties
- Speech and language delay; expressive more affected than receptive
- Some students are minimally verbal; AAC may be appropriate
- ADHD features: inattention, hyperactivity, impulsivity
- Autism spectrum features in some
- Anxiety; behavioral rigidity; difficulty with transitions
- Sensory sensitivities; repetitive movements or behaviors
- Affectionate, sociable disposition often reported

PHYSICAL & SENSORY CONSIDERATIONS

- Hypotonia (low muscle tone); motor coordination difficulties
- Fine motor challenges; handwriting may be affected
- Gait abnormalities; fatigue may affect stamina during the school day
- Epilepsy or seizures in some; seizure response plan may be needed
- Vision anomalies: strabismus, nystagmus, or refractive errors
- Hearing impairment in some; can affect learning and speech
- Sleep disturbances may affect daytime attention and behavior
- Short stature; physical features are typically mild and subtle
- Difficulty with personal safety awareness
- Limited independence with daily living tasks in some

FOR THIS SCHOOL APPOINTMENT

Questions drawn from published research, clinician observations, and experiences reported by families across the broader SETD5 Syndrome community.

QUESTIONS TO RAISE

- Is our child eligible for an IEP or 504 Plan?
- Which evaluations should be included in the eligibility assessment?
- Should speech-language therapy, occupational therapy, and physical therapy be included?
- Would AAC (augmentative and alternative communication) be appropriate?
- What assistive technology options are available?

CLASSROOM & SUPPORT CONSIDERATIONS

- How can the classroom support a 'spiky' cognitive profile?
- What sensory accommodations might help our child?
- How can we build in predictable routines and minimize transitions?
- How should the team handle behavioral differences and anxiety?
- What progress monitoring will be in place, and how will we stay informed?

GENE	INHERITANCE	ELIGIBILITY	OMIM	RESOURCE
SETD5 (chromosome 3p25.3)	Typically de novo; can be inherited (AD)	Typically qualifies for an IEP under IDEA	#615761	setd5syndrome.live

More information, plain-language research summaries, and a medical terms guide are available at setd5syndrome.live. This document is for informational purposes only and does not constitute medical advice. Always consult your child's medical team for guidance specific to your situation. Prepared by setd5syndrome.live — a family-created resource.

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